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From the Chief Editor's desk



“Unmesha” a mystic knack for thought dispersal and word transcendence.

Agamas are also called *Prakriya Shastra*. These are compilation of *Upayas* or various shortcuts to otherwise tedious and strenuous methods of conventional yoga. The tantric secret about *vikalpakshaya & vikalpa sanaskara* is based on a human arcane knowledge of Cognitive Thought constructed in a sophisticated parlance as caricatured on various configurations of eight groups of alphabets. A refined and well-oriented mindset is easy to transcend whereas an unruly deranged one like a gripping mindset requires more energy to block and transcend. The underlying streamline of subjective consciousness has two inlets into its realm. The first at the termination of the preceding thought construct and the second at the beginning of the following thought constructs. The intermediate span of thoughtlessness makes room for the perpetually extent substratum of unconditioned consciousness.

The intermittent state of word transcendence has been categorised by Maheshwarabhinavagupt as उन्मिश्रता उन्मिश्रत् उन्मिश्रितम् । The preceding two categories are prone to admit deranged thought constructs and cause more of *vikalpa* or unrefined imageries. The continuation of unmesha is akin to what some schools of yoga philosophy call *vyuthan samskar nirrodha* (resisting the impetus of extrovert out flux.) The third category leads to assimilation into the essential nature . *Yatah* may refer to both time and space . Since the gap between termination and origin of two thought constructs lies within the domain of subjective consciousness the term *yatah* refers to the point of subsiding of any arbitrary thought construct . This is the point of the origin of the consequent one . The *Karika* does not mention a deliberate resistance to the cropping up of another thought but emphasises on adhering to the substratum. This in turn spontaneously prevents any consequent thought construct . Once the knack of seance into the origin of all thoughts is mastered there is no consequent thought. This last phase is mentioned as *unmishitam* or fully extant unmesha with minimal danger of pel mel influx of deranged and unruly thoughts and getting caught in the quagmire of reciprocating objectivity .

A trick from *Vijnan Bhairav* makes the process of word transcendence precise and distinct . For an alphabetic transcendence the aspirant needs to focus on the preceding and the following span of “void” or expressionless void. A yogi enters the realm of absolute unconditioned consciousness with zero objectivity . Besides a mystic trance this mindset of absolute righteousness can be a great spiritual impetus for all intuitive undertakings and for developing business or political acumen . In this eon of rat race of indiscriminate pursuit such mystic disruptions can provide recess for progressive innovation .

*यस्य कस्यापि वर्णस्य पूर्वातावनुभावयेत्

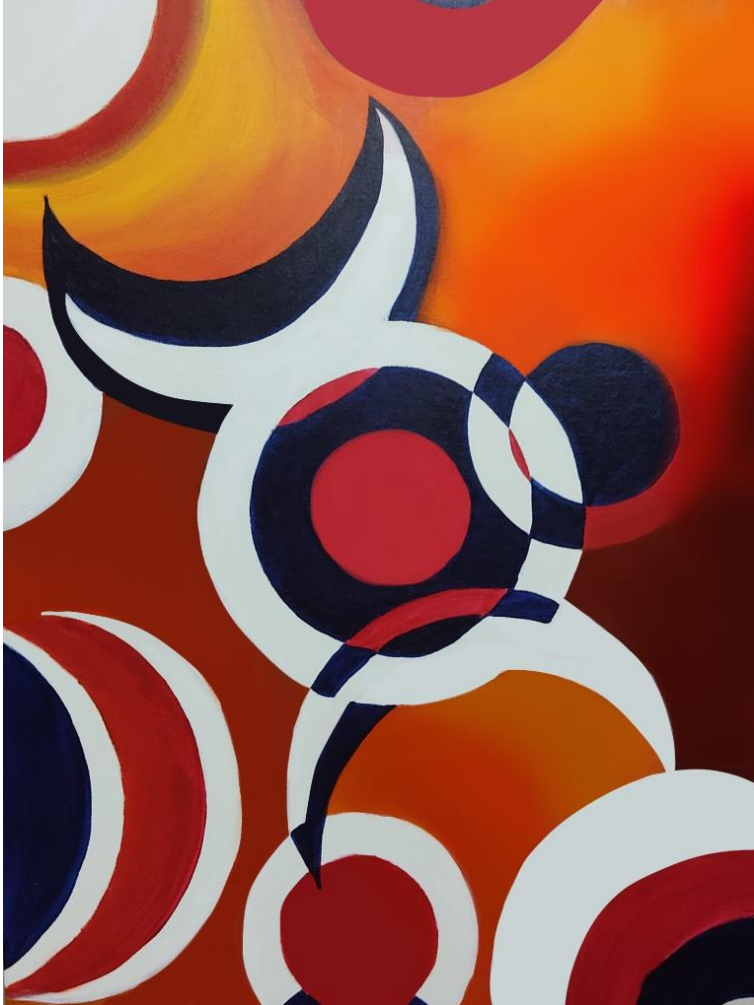
शून्यस्य शून्यभूतौसौ शून्याकारःपुमान्भवेत्।

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Intertwine by Tarini Kher

Editorial

A question that has baffled aspirants all through history is the possibility of the coexistence of mystic and mundane simultaneously. Seers have often dealt with this idea and have come up with symbolic imageries and mythic content to illustrate the same. While from the point of view of totality (purna) such differences don't even exist yet a fallacious mindset, conditioned and limited tries to find an equivalent of a mystic or mythical truth in the mundane. The attempt is as futile as trying to locate a criminal in a mystery novel in one's neighbourhood. Searching for truth is a sure-shot method for never finding it. Truth needs to dawn rather than to be found. Here I am reminded of Bishop Ambrose's words, "It is not the man that finds the truth, but it is the truth that finds the man" which sowed the seeds of divine love in St Augustine's heart for ever. The problem in searching for the 'Truth' is to accept that it is not present in us and in a way deny oneself the knowledge of the self which is all encompassing. Trying to find in complicated cryptic writings what a truly loving and joyful heart can unravel in matter of seconds is a pitiable state. To find a logical meaning in art has often proved to be a futile attempt. More and more artists are turning towards open-ended creations which leave things open for interpretation and hence facilitate the viewer/reader/spectator to create their versions of the work of art in their minds and hearts.

Explaining the importance of transcending the conditioned mindset our Guru Maharaj Swami Paranand Tirth ji in his enlightening editorial talks about various 'upayas' (short-cuts) mentioned in tantrik texts which help genuine aspirants to go beyond and transcend the 'vikalpa' or unrefined imageries. Besides a mystic trance this mindset of absolute righteousness can be a great spiritual impetus for all intuitive undertakings and for developing business or political acumen.

Next we have Swamiji's extremely profound translation and exposition on first two verses of 'Neel Saraswati Stotram' from 'Brihanneel Tantra'. Devi worship since time immemorial has provided the key to aspirants who want to transcend and yet enjoy the fruits of this world (Bhukti-Mukti Artham, of Laghustava). To worship the mother is to seek her blessings in this world and hereafter and to get drenched in her love is to lose oneself in a pool of bliss even while engaged in a mundane activity. Swamiji has succinctly explained the meaning of symbols used in Mother Tara's iconography like the corpse, three eyes, mudras and the presence of a snake in her dread locks.

Following this we have a scholarly write up by Niraj Kumar, an excerpt from the speech he made at the launch of his erudite book on 'Kalachakra Tantra'. Focussing on the importance of the Nalanda tradition and the importance of reviving it he tries to locate the mystic land of 'Shambala' somewhere in India. "To decipher this coded text composed in twilight language was a dream of luminaries like Rahul Sankrityayan, Nicholas Roerich, Blavatsky and so forth; I could do it sitting in Nirman Bhawan in Lutyens Delhi. Under the ongoing Central Vista project, a stupa holding the sacred relics of Buddha will be built at the centre of the Vista. All these are auspicious indications of rebuilding of our Buddhist heritage. My pentalogy on this extraordinary text is a small tribute to grant masters of Nalanda and the dynamic sanatan parampara of Bharat" writes the author

Next we have the translation and exposition on two sutras (9th and 10th) of Pratyabhijna Hrdayam by Kshemraj from the YTA study circle. The issue ends with a brief photo essay on few temples of Bhutan by Geetika.

NEEL SARASWATI STOTRAM**(A Hymn to the sapphire goddess of wisdom from Brihanneel Tantra)**

There is a legend that sage Vashishta spent a lifetime trying to seek favours of goddess Tara. He would remain engrossed in severe penance on the shore of the ocean. When nothing came out of it, he lost his patience and cursed the deity – it is said that one associate deity of mother Tara incarnated before him and advised him that he had been worshipping her in a wrong way. He must go to mahachina [Tibet] and worship her according to Buddhist rites and rituals. Sage Vashishtha did go there and confronted Lord Buddha at Mount Kailash – he had a word with him regarding the doctrine of *nissvabhata* [essence-lessness].

Various doctrines are conceptualized to befit the requirements of the aspirants of varying competencies and temperaments at various times. When excessive infatuation in external sense objects, rapid and indiscriminately divergent courses would make the mindset of humankind too tumultuous to bring in faith in any existing system of metaphysics, Buddhism would be the only consistent solution. Although Vedanta monism defines emancipation in terms of absolute annihilation of disagreeable and the attainment of absolute bliss i.e., Paramanand, a disproportionate preoccupation of the world mind with finding a way for a partial or total eradication of all miseries would rule out the striving for ultimate bliss – this is just where the realm of Buddhism begins.

Tara was a buffer deity of learning and wisdom during the historical phase of speedy propagation of Buddhism, as Hindu Pundits found it irrelevant to go by the ecclesiastic discipline of acquiring Vedic and non -Vedic education. From a doctrinal standpoint, Paramanand or absolute bliss of emancipation was substituted by a semiotic depiction of various philosophic ideologies. Tara was the deity of vindication and assertion of a particular creed by two rivals. One of whom would not admit the Vedas as any metaphysical testimony of evidence and another would be producing his counterargument before the former, despite their unswerving faith in the Vedic dictum. Mother Tara came to be worshipped by the Hindus as well the Buddhists. There is a famous Vedic mantra –

“yo, apsu navam pratishhitam ved pratyev tisthati”

‘One who knows the mystery behind the boat in deep waters attains unison with the substratum.’

In the mystic and esoteric tradition of Shankara's monism, Tara is worshipped as the presiding deity of Shakya darshanam the doctrine of Shakya ----- and she is worshipped for pacifying the fear of floods and tornadoes.

नौकासिंहासनासीनाशाक्यदर्शनदेवता जलापच्छमनीं वंदे तारांवारिदमेचकाम्।

“noka simhasanaseenam Shakya darshan devatam

jalapat shamanim Vande taram varidmechakam.”

‘I prostrate to Tara the presiding deity of the doctrine of Shakyamuni, She boards a boat and delivers her flock from flood and other aquatic turbulence.’

The Buddhist world worships her as ‘the mother of the Buddha ‘ or the Alma mater of enlightened beings. One of her popular Tibetan hymn describes her as the personification of the sacred syllable ‘Om.’

“Om Chen dende ma pag mala drolmala drolmala chagtse lo.”

Tar is yet another synonym for the sacred syllable प्रणवः so the feminine aspect of tar is the Shakti of this nomenclature of God Almighty or Ishwara.

तस्य वाचकः प्रणवः । तज्जपस्तदर्थभावनम् ।

His nomination is Pranav and its Japa or repetition is a meditation on its meaning. Another parallel term in Christian mysticism is “startz” who is an entity responsible for observance and promotion of Christian precepts presumably the origin of “voices in the heads”. Without going into the details of a priori and a posteriori we can assume that such methods have been essential features of all mystic cults . In a compilation of Christian mysticism named -Philokalia ,there is an account of hermit monks who could foresee that some pilgrim were not destined to reach their cloister, this could be possible through this phenomena of staretz. Yet another hermit monk dictated an entire volume on Christian mysticism to a novice monk situated elsewhere in a cubicle, miles away from his preceptor . The best part of it is that the novice monk who jotted down the canon has attributed the authorship to his preceptor and not himself. This is another feat of what we worship as Tara in Hinduism and Buddhism . Tara as it were is absolutely secular, besides all misgivings of mundane intrigues, she also redeems her aspirants from the hackneyed ecclesiastic obligations which are not relevant anymore. She is the deity of eloquence, puns , alliterations and entendres, especially the goddess of modern creativity, where breaking loose from the conventional norms is more significant than Methodism or traditionalism. Her devotee needs no ablution, rites or rituals. Just remembering her as the most intimate and innately related entity is sufficient. There is a massive compilation named ‘Tara Bhakti Sudharnav’ in Bengali and her Tibetan version is ubiquitous in every Gumpa and prayer flag – her sketch as a beautiful deity sitting on a flake of cloud carrying a stalk of sunflower and hands locked in a mudra called tatwa mudra with blessing trickling from it and entering the hearts of those who remember her, those who can remember her and also those who cannot even remember her! Her ten syllable mantra (ओंतारेतुत्तारे तुरे स्वाहा) and some hymn are popular among some Hindu devotees too . One

hymn called “Tarakarpurraja stotra” permits even some drinking, dancing and party. So owing to some hedonistic omission and commission in this cult [traditionally known as Mahachinachara], even comparatively lax aspirants also have a way.

The sapphire goddess as succour .

मातर्नीलसरस्वति प्रणमतां सौभाग्यसम्पत्प्रदे

प्रत्यालीढपदस्थिते शवहृदि स्मेराननाम्भोरुहे।

फुल्लेन्दीवरलोचनत्रययुते कर्तीकपालोत्पले

खड्गं चादधती त्वमेव शरणं त्वामीश्वरीमाश्रये ॥ १ ॥

O! Mother Tara [Neel Sarswati] you bestow good luck and affluence on those who make obeisance to you. You stamp a corpse [Shiva without you is a corpse] under your feet, your lotus like a face is ever smiling. You have three eyes like lotuses in full bloom, and carry a scissor, blue lotus, a skull and a sword in your four hands. O great ruler I seek refuge in thee.

There are three variants of Tara each with a specific hue, viz, neel tara, white tara and red tara. In Indian tantras and also in some Vajrayana texts, the trio is worshiped as - Neel Saraswati, Ugratara and Ek jata. This hymn as the name goes, pertains to Neel Saraswati or the blue goddess of wisdom and knowledge.

The all consuming and all pervading blue colour, sky blue, ocean blue, navy blue or ink blue has always been a source of mystic insight to yogis and meditators. The blue ether pervades the entire universal phenomena. As per mystic semiotics, the colour blue is related more to hearing and listening than smelling, tasting, seeing and touching. The Word of god which manifests in its three forms related to the word of Brahma Vishnu and Rudra (ब्रह्मवाग्रूपिणी विष्णुवाग्रूपिणी रुद्रवाग्रूपिणी), pervades the entire gross subtle and causal ether.

From a metaphysical good fortune and riches, come submission and docility. The hymn says you bestow these two to those who anayas make obeisance to you. One popular hymn to lord shiva says

नकस्याप्युन्नत्यै भवतिशिरसस्त्वय्यवनतिः।

‘who doesn’t prosper by bowing down his head at your feet ?’ .

Affluence and grandeur are also attained through victory and subjugation but these are not lasting. On the other hand faith and devotion lead to lasting and permanent affluence that lasts through many generations in this world and the kingdom of heaven or emancipation after demise.

The gesture and pose of trampling with one foot -आलीढ।

Pratyaleedh is a mudra in ancient Sanskrit dramaturgy. A gesture, mind set or body language meant for an emphatic depiction of a specification has been termed as mudra. In pratyaleedh, a gesture of subjugation and supremacy, the heroine puts her left foot on the chest of the hero who lies exhausted and almost lifeless on his back. The other leg is slightly bent at the knee and rests on the ground on the toes. These are more like semiotic depictions of various tantric axioms pertaining to a particular school of thought. Shakti or nature dominates in the practice of shakti upaya where only prakriti plays a vital role and proceeds independently or arbitrarily. The power as consciousness accomplishes all five functions independently i.e., without any motivation and assistance from the conditioned deities of these five functions viz., creation, sustenance, dissolution, veiling and redemption which are Brahma, Vishnu, Rudra, Ishwar and Sadashiv respectively. The moribund figure under mother Tara's foot as it were, is Sadashiv since Paramshiva, her eternal consort adorns her dread lock in the form of a celestial serpent - Akshobhya. The unswerving one.

The corpse

Sadashiva contains the entire objective phenomena within his domain of excess subjective awareness. After his seventeenth digit the entire objective phenomena is totally transcended and only pure ahanta remains. In sadashiva state, the trace of objectivity may cause an exterior out flux of awareness and lead to ishvara state from where it takes an assiduous impulse of ahanta to regain the sadashiva and higher states. Thus, MantraMaheshwar is this realm, and are absorbed in a state just immediate to their essential nature which is akin to state of accomplished yogis who are dead to the world and never lose sight of their unison with the ultimate shiva.

Smiling profile of Tara mata is an expression of enjoying the incessant bliss following the relinquishing of all relative subjective and objective perceptions. The state of eternal bliss is the pure subjective consciousness that accounts for the consciousness of objective as well as that of subjective portions of the universal phenomena. Unlike Sundari kula, there is no specification of five faced Sadashiv in Tara kulam. Instead Akshobhya shiva is depicted as the celestial serpent. As per one school of shri krama (order of worship) called सादिविद्या or the Vidya beginning with syllable स. All remaining four pretas or corpses culminate into one Sadashiv whose five faces symbolise the same. (Compare panch pret asana scena, seated on the five corpses and प्रत्यालीढपदस्थिते शवहृदि). Ancient dramaturgy tells us that eyes dilate as a gesture of experience of joy and pleasure प्रीत्युत्फुल्ल विलोचना 'with the eyes widely dilated while experiencing bliss and joy on a smiling and happy face, is another speciality in the profile of mother Tara.

There is a verse in Chandi charitra

अनायस्तानाना देवीस्तूयमाना सुरऋषिभिः

मुमोचासुरदेहेषु शस्त्राण्यस्त्राणि चेश्वरी ।।

During the ferocious battle with demons which usually causes furious facial contortions and red-shot wrath-full eyes as an expression of excess ire and fury - the divine mother had a relaxed and placid composure while being felicitated by seers and sages, even as she was shooting weapons tremendously at the army of demons.

Even while trampling all objective phenomena with all her might under her feet leaving no chance of its cropping again, mother Tara while blending with her blissful nature bears

the same composure on her face. Her lotus like face smiling and the three eyes gleaming with diving bliss. Most of tara devotees like to worship her as the embodiment of consolidate bliss and will.

Mystery of The three eyes. A three dimensional perspective of truth.

Agamic texts divide the entire phenomena into three dimensions; subjective, objective and their threshold . These are called pramata, pramana and pramey in Shaiva and Shakta metaphysics. These three are signified by fire , sun and the moon . All smart and tantrik entities are invariably three eyed and this blends with the axiom of the notion of completeness as comprising subjective objective and perspectives and their admixture . The author of Maharath Manjari mentions the three eyes as murti chakras with seventeen ,twelve and ten kalas or digits pertaining to each chakra respectively . Mongolian variant of Tara however has six eyes all over her profile denoting her pure subjective conscious nature and being the agency of perceptions of smell ,taste,vision,touch and sound.

Nishpann yogavali describes the three eyes of various deities as round furious and red shot . But mother Tara who is adored as the mother of enlightened beings has beautiful compassionate and benevolent eyes . There is a Tibetan legend about the origin of Tara and Bhrikuti from the two tear drops of Avalokiteshwara as he cogitated on the poignant plight to which all sentient beings were subjected . The two tears of sheer compassion turned into two ponds and thus into two goddesses of compassion and wisdom . A pilgrim comes across these two ponds as he circumambulates the austere mount Kailash .

Blue lotus in bloom lilacs are the semiotic depictions of compassion love peace and amicability . Scissors signify the termination of reciprocating of logorrhea impulse where as skull is the small perceiver or Maya pramata and the sword of wisdom severs this co ditto Ed experience to make room for wholistic and universal viewpoint .

Severing imperfect world view is the first step towards refinement and exactitude beyond the cognitive system. The cognitive system with all its functions only limits and constricts the universal vision which is why Jñāna, or conditioned knowledge has been said to be the cause of nescience in the shiv sutras . The benevolent shakti of shiva removes this blockage and opens the vistas of pure unconditioned subjective awareness which finally leads to the restoration of an innate unison with shiva -the perfect being. The heart conscience and notion of agreeability is symbolized by a sunflower in Mongolian Tara .

Surrender to shakti.

A total surrender has six aspects . अनुकूलस्य संकल्पःप्रतिकूलस्य वर्जनम्
आत्मनिक्षेपकार्पण्ये गोप्तृत्ववरणं तथा रक्षिष्यतीतिविश्वासः षड्विधा शरणागतिः।

Resolving to be agreeable and avoiding whatever is disagreeable to the lord.

Totally surrendering oneself to her will piety ,and a strong faith that the lord is my succour and saviour. A total surrender and submission, docility meekness and piety.

I seek resort in thee the supreme empress and the universal mother .

वाचामीश्वरि भक्तकल्पलतिके सर्वार्थसिद्धीश्वरि

सद्यः प्राकृतगद्यपद्यरचनासर्वार्थसिद्धिप्रदे।

नीलेन्दीवरलोचनत्रययुते कारुण्यवारांनिधे

सौभाग्यामृतवर्षणेन कृपया सिञ्च त्वमस्मादृशम् ॥ २ ॥

You are the governess of expression. Like a wish fulfilling creeper, you fulfill all wishes of your devotees. By your grace one attains poesy and creative skills in vernaculars within no time. O mother with three lotus- like eyes you are the ocean of compassion. Please drench a hapless person like me with your benedictory shower of good fortune.

There is an adage among the mystic grammarians.

What is known as Ishwara, is the state of pashyanti vak among the sagacious grammarians. The three gross, subtle and causal stages of manifestation correspond to the four modes of speech or vak viz., vaikhari, madhyama, pashyanti and para. The third one is in thermal unison with the lord so some thinkers do not count it as a separate mode. Para or the transcendental vak is the most sophisticated expression of the popular Devi Durga who is adored by millions of devotees in various ways. Hence, the transcendental speech or para is exactly what is, wanted by the term devi says Maheshwar Abhinav Gupta in his gloss on the tantric text -*Paratrishika*.

The empress of all expression or the power of consciousness which accounts for the word and meaning relationship can be rationally defined as the empress of all expressions, since she underlies the whole process of cosmic modification of vak from causal to subtle and from subtle to gross and vice versa.

Desiring process as such springs forth from the core of the word, which means no one can desire or want anything that cannot be expressed in words. Samkalpa or the preceding stage of will depends on various stages of manifestations of vak. Kalplata is wishfulfilling creeper which in this parlance can be semiotically analogous to a vine with its roots in the avyakrit or the un-manifest. The germination sprouts as the cotyledons of word and meaning are just about to separate. This is followed by a stem and foliage, bearing **branches** of distinct words and meanings which bears the flowers of righteous will and yields the desired objective.

This creeper of vak germinates in para stage and bifurcates in pashyanti stage, and further sprouts into foliages in madhyama stage of individual reason and finally ,manifests as the expressed and audible word in the stage called vaikhari or the gross expression.

Yog kundalini upanisad says that this process can be reversed, and through word transcendence an aspirant can enter the realm of pure righteousness and refined will. In this realm of pashyanti and para, all dreams come true. One conceives just what has to happen and just what is going to happen. This is the arena of pure truth and righteousness where the presiding deity of all modes of speech exists, mother Tara becomes a wish fulfilling vine to her devout aspirants.

Since the agency that accounts for word and meaning, relationship is also the divine mother, there is no disparity between ideation and materialisation, the former being word, and the latter an expression of meaning. Sarvarth sidhi accomplishment is also defined as

unison with the complete or whole. Tantrik canons maintain that the whole comprises thirty six elementary constituents of the universal phenomena as the meaning part of it, and the third and sixth consonants of the Sanskrit alphabet as the word part of it. The two are called shabdi and arthi Srishti i.e., creation, as word and creation are in eternal unison, their transcendence alone can lead an aspirant to the accomplishment of “all”. The pursuit of conditioned fragments of the phenomena is a perpetuated process with imperfect desiring as its impetus can never lead to completion. Accomplishing everything totally and completely can be possible by a total rejection of pursuit of small fragments through intense dispassion and equally intense passion for attaining the complete or Purna. Creativity and aesthetic pursuit invariably have their roots in the mystic core of human psyche.

Munificence of the divine mother as the guru.

Women are not entitled to be gurus in any other offshoot of oriental spirituality. Only Tara cult permits women to be a guru. This may be so owing to their proficiency in vernacular or desh bhasha. The teachings in Buddhism and certain oriental cults can be imparted in any language not necessarily Sanskrit therefore Prakrit speaking women could also serve as preceptors. The author of Maharath Manjiri, a popular tantric canon received the Gathas dictated to him by one Sumukhi devi in Prakrit apabhraṃś. Also the two daughters of his guru Shambhunath(?) namely Kanakavati and Keyuravati are also said to be his preceptors. This cult of Tara is the most lenient. The first guru of an infant is his mother who refines and develops his speech from indistinct gaga goo goo to well articulated expressions. The Tara manifestation of a guru specially language guru helps the acolyte develop stupendous eloquence and highly sophisticated expression. All such avatars can be aptly designated as forms of mother Tara. There is another rationale about the overall aspect of a guru. The guru male or female rears the shishu or spiritual tutelage the way a mother raises her child, hence the metaphoric superlative mouli or mother for a guru specially in some regions in Maharashtra. Even Vithhal is also addressed as mouli owing to his motherly care for his devotees. The term mauli for a guru occurs frequently in Marathi devotion literature.

The nectar of good fortune सौभाग्यामृतम्।

One of the popular meditations on mother Tara prescribes small droplets or rays of nectar trickling from the juncture of her ring finger and thumb which are joined in a gesture or mudra called tattwa mudra or the gesture of suchness. The devotee is required to feel that his gross subtle and causal bodies are being drenched by that nectar. In yet another method the divine mother is meditating upon as seated on the crown of the head and three rays of this elixir of good fortune are radiating from her forehead, throat and heart and enter the devotees head, throat and heart. These are white, red and blue in color and presumably denote the purification of mind speech and body. Even without such practice an ardent devotee can derive benefits by seeking her favours through psalmodysing.

To be continued .

English rendering and exposition by

Varni Paratpar swarup

Kalacakra Tantra and Shambhala: A Brief Note

Nalanda premise has captivated Eurasia for centuries. Why would Chinese Tripitaka masters, Korean monks, Tibetans, Tangut, Javanese aristocracy, Burmese scholar visit the premise thousand years ago when both overland and maritime journey was dangerous? There must be something special that ‘something’ is not the building, or the gates guarded by the scholars, or the number of teachers or students . It was the Nalanda tradition of knowledge. What exactly was “Nalanda Tradition”? The answer can be found by exploring the last major Buddhist text composed in India, Kalacakra tantra. Kalacakra tantra is the guidebook of Nalanda tradition. But, the Kalacakra tantra in popular imagination is that of Kalacakra ceremonies organized by Tibetan masters. And these elaborate rituals appear unintelligible to a distant observer.

The Kalacakra public ceremonies itself is a new phenomenon. Japan had imposed 21 demands on China in 1915. That included freedom to build Buddhist temples in China. Chinese Buddhists were outraged, since they felt humiliated that the disciples of Chinese Buddhism world teach back Buddhism to China. We all know how Mahayana Buddhism was carried from India to China & then from China to Japan.

Japanese Buddhists, particularly esoteric sect of Shingon School, argued that even though Japan inherited Buddhism from China; tantric Buddhism has been preserved and active in Japan; while China lost the Tantric school. In fact tantras from Nalanda was taken to Chinese Court by Vajrabodhi, Amoghavajra and Shubhakarasimha during early 8th Century.

Chinese Buddhist then found Tibetan Tantra for their tantric revival movement. Moreover, Tibetan Tantra was imported directly from India, thus it was to be treated as more authentic, compared with Japanese esoteric Buddhism.

The Republic of China invited the then ninth Panchen Lama to Tibet. It was this Panchen Lama, Thubten Chokyi Nyima, who started holding public ceremonies of Kalacakra Tantra. He held 9 such ceremonies. On Oct 21-24, 1932, he held a huge ceremony in the Hall of Supreme Harmony at the centre of the Forbidden Palace in Beijing attended by 1 lakh audience.

Let us see how Shambhala from Kalacakra Tantra became a central point for modern age philosophers, transcendentalists and new age gurus. The sixth Panchen Lama had written an imaginary travel account of Shambhala in 1775- '*Shambhala Lam-yig*'.

The Shambhala myth was picked up by the subsequent Panchen Lamas. In one of the essays, Hungarian explorer of Himalayas Csomo de Koros put-Shambhala-the 'source or origin of Happiness' between 45 degree and 50-degree North latitude in his 1833 essay on 'Note on the Origin of the Kalacakra and Adi-Buddha system'. This was the first western account on the Kalacakra system.

Helena Blavatsky, the founder of Theosophist movement put Shambhala in 'Gobi Desert' (*Secret Doctrine* 2.39) and prophesized that the last kalki Avatar would come from Shambhala.

Some scholars in their work have explored how Blavatsky herself was being guided by Panchen Lama's emissary, one Djwhal Khul or DK

David and Nancy Reigle, Sanskrit scholars based in the US claims that Blavatsky's magnum opus *Secret Doctrine* was based on Root text of Kalacakra Tantra.

Blavatsky's propagation of Shambhala myth was twisted by Ninth Panchen Lama; who infact started putting Shambhala in Tibet during early 20th century. And that the Panchen Lama himself will be reborn as the last Kalki who would eliminate barbarians and establish Buddha dharma. On the other hand, adopting Csomo de Koros version, Mongol historians claimed that Shambhala was in Mongolia and Chengez Khan was a Kalki King.

Mongolis also wrote visionary travel account mythical Sambhala.

A place Khamariin Khiid in Gobi Desert is being popularized as Shambhala. It was established in 1830 by mystic- scholar Danzan Ravajaa. In recent times, an American scholar on Kalacakra tantra, is popularizing the narrative that this Shambhala is exactly below the Sukhavati heaven where Buddha Amitabh resides in his enjoyment body.

Then, Shambhala was also termed as Shangrila in western discourse. James Hilton propagated a small place in Himalaya as Shangrila or Shambhala in his 1933 novel, *Lost Horizon*.

Then one comes across account how China declared a small prefecture Deqing as Shangrila, officially in 1997.

Where is Shambhala? What is Shambhala? If Shambhala is where the Kalacakra Tantra originated, how did it become capsule of Nalanda tradition?

When one deciphers the text of the Kalacakra Tantra, one realizes Shambhala cannot be located so north, if it was a real geography. In Shambhala, the list of eatables are, दधि गुड सहितं पोलिका मोदकं curd, jaggery, *puri* and laddu. Then the text clearly mentions that Shambhala is encircled by plain mountains; while Kailash is encircled by the snow-capped mountains.

It is certain Shambhala is in tropical region, close to Indian habits and customs.

This Tantra needs to be fully studied from the perspective of the composer to grasp its essence. Naropa was the composer of this king of tantras.

This Shambhala prophecies in modern times can be seen as consequence of de Koros's erratic interpretation of the text. He, without understanding of astronomy wrongly assumed Shambhala between 45-50-degree latitude. And this mistake was not rechecked and adopted by subsequent story-tellers.

There are five chapters in the Kalacakra Tantra containing 1047 verses. Apart from establishing authorship of Kalacakra Tantra with Naropa, it is apparent that the epoch period of the Kalacakra calendar coincides with disappearance of Guru Padmasambhava.

Surprisingly, 14th Dalai Lama, who continued Kalacakra ceremonies after early demise of Panchen Lama, composed a panegyrics for 17 Nalanda Panditas and the list does not include both Naropa and Padamsahbhava. The website of Dalai Lama shows Kalacakra Tantra having been composed in Central Asia, based upon unfounded story telling by some western scholar.

But, Kalacakra Tantra is truly Indian in character. It is the guidebook of the Nalanda Tradition. The attempt at de-Indianization of this tradition cannot be countered if India does not reOwn the last phase of Buddhism. Just like there was revival of Buddhism in China a century ago when *chela* Japan attempted to browbeat China with its own variant of Buddhism; India being the permanent Guru, needs to reOwn Buddhism. India can no longer play second fiddle to the mutant versions of Buddhism being pushed by chelas against our citizens in the northern periphery.

To decipher this coded text composed in twilight language was a dream of luminaries like Rahul Sankrityayan, Nicholas Roerich, Blavatsky and so forth; I could do it sitting in Nirman Bhawan in Lutyens Delhi. Under the ongoing Central Vista project, a stupa holding the sacred relics of Buddha will be built at the centre of the Vista. All these are auspicious indications of rebuilding of our Buddhist heritage. My pentalogy on this extraordinary text is a small tribute to grant masters of Nalanda and the dynamic sanatan parampara of Bharat.

Niraj Kumar

(Excerpt from Speech made during the book release function organized by the IGNCA at Janapath, New Delhi on 22 July 2022).

Pratyabhijna made easy 9th and 10th Aphorism**चिद्वत्चिच्छक्तिसंकोचान्मलावृतः संसारी।****Sutra: Chidvat Chshakti Samkocat Malavratah Samsari**

Translation: Of His own accord whenever the Parameshwara whose essential nature is consciousness undergoes conditioning in his Shaktis of will, knowledge, action etc. he becomes samsari or divergent.

Exposition:

This conditioning, however, is apparent so the Parmeshwara seems to have become conditioned and divergent whereas in his essential nature he is unconditioned pure subjective consciousness unalloyed by even an idea of subjectivity. The samsari undergoes a dissipation of Shaktis as he gets divergent and becomes Shakti Daridra-“pauper” in Shakti but as he accumulates Shaktis to transcend these conditioning he becomes what he is in his essential nature i.e., Siva.

Now how do we know that all pervasive consciousness that is Shiva alone has undergone contraction and limitation. There should be some evidence of the fact that Shiva alone becomes Samsari of his own accord. The next aphorism says

Tathapi Tadvat Panch Krityani Karoti**Questions**

- 1) The Shakti's of Parameshwara are
 - a- Conditioned
 - b- Unconditioned
 - c- Unconditioned but appear to be conditioned
- 2) The conditioning of Parameshwara's infinitude is
 - a- Owing to his Shakti
 - b- Impossible
 - c- Of his own accord
 - d- None of these
- 3) The number of malas or taints as per this commentary are
 - a- 5
 - b- 3
 - c- 1
 - d- None of these
- 4) Match the following

a- Omniscience	1. Kala
b- Omnipotence	2. Raga
c- All pervasiveness	3. Niyati
d- Eternity	4. Vidya
e- Omnipresence	5. Kal
- 5) Explain 'Shakti daridra' (Impoverished in Shakti)

Pratyabhijna made easy .**तथापितद्वत् पंचकृत्यानि करोति ।**

Sutra: “Tathapi Tadvat Panch Krityani Karoti”

Translation : Despite being tainted the divergent empirical soul performs the five-fold functions like Parameshwara

Exposition:

Tathapi: Notwithstanding

Tadvat: Like the Parameshwara

Panchkrityani: Performs the five functions like Parameshwara

The most cardinal difference between the votaries of Brahmadvait (monism of Absolute Brahma) and Ishvaradvait (Ishvar as the monistic principle) – is that the former propounds an absolute principle who performs no function. A knower of Brahman who has become Brahman in turn is beyond all functions pertaining to Creation, Sustenance and Dissolution etc. (Jagat Vyapar Varjyam) (Brahma Sutras)

Ishvaradvait on the other hand propounds that the all pervasive consciousness as Lord Shiva always performs the five functions. The lord Creates, Sustains, Dissolves, Removes his devotees miseries and Blesses them with the supreme wisdom (Svacchanda Tantra).

Since the Lord undergoes an expansion of his form as he manifests in the form of asuddha adhvas in order to create, sustain etc. his power of consciousness or Chit Shakti gets conditioned. He continues carrying out these five functions even while he is divergent and becomes ‘samsari’. The lord even as divergent and extrovert projects the entities nascent within him without pervading gross bodies, prana etc. (Pratyabhijna Karika).

The all conscious Maheswara, on getting divergent and pervading the realms of body, prana etc. , illuminates conditioned time, space etc. In the portions in which He illuminates time space etc. He is the creator, illuminating the portions other than mentioned above He is the destroyer, with respect to the illuminations of appearances like blue etc. He is the sustainer. He is the dissolver when it comes to distinction from the portion of appearance. By illuminating the aspirant as in unison with the all conscious Prakash, He performs the act of Anugraha. Thus these are the five fold functions of the supreme lord (For detail study refer to Spand-Sandoh).

This great grandeur of the lord is also exhibited in the aspirant who also experiences the lord as their innermost self with strong commitment. The doership of the five functions of the lord is also exhibited in those who have realized Shiva as their essential nature and since they know the origin and expanse of the universal phenomena they are called Jeevan mukta. Jeevan mukta’s are the realized souls who are emancipated even while living.

On the other hand those who do not know this and are confined to the experience of only the objective phenomena are always bound.

From YTA study circle .

Photo Essay**Glimpses from a soul-searching journey in the land of Thunder Dragon**

Paying homage to Mother Tara at Tara Lhakhang, Pangri Zampa, Thimpu



Praying for the light of knowledge to dawn at Tango Monastery near Thimpu



Seeking answers in quiet and mystical atmosphere of Chimi Lhakhang, Punakha





Peaceful Paradise, Buddha Dordenma, Thimpu (Buddha Point)



First glimpse of the colossal Buddha



Ugyen Pema Woedling Zangthopelri near Paro



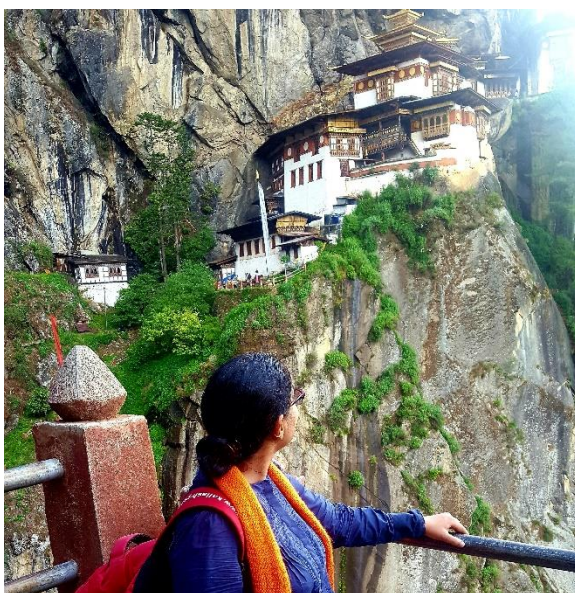
On the way to Taktsang (Tiger's Nest), Seeking Guru Padmasambhava's blessings



Speechless at Taktsang

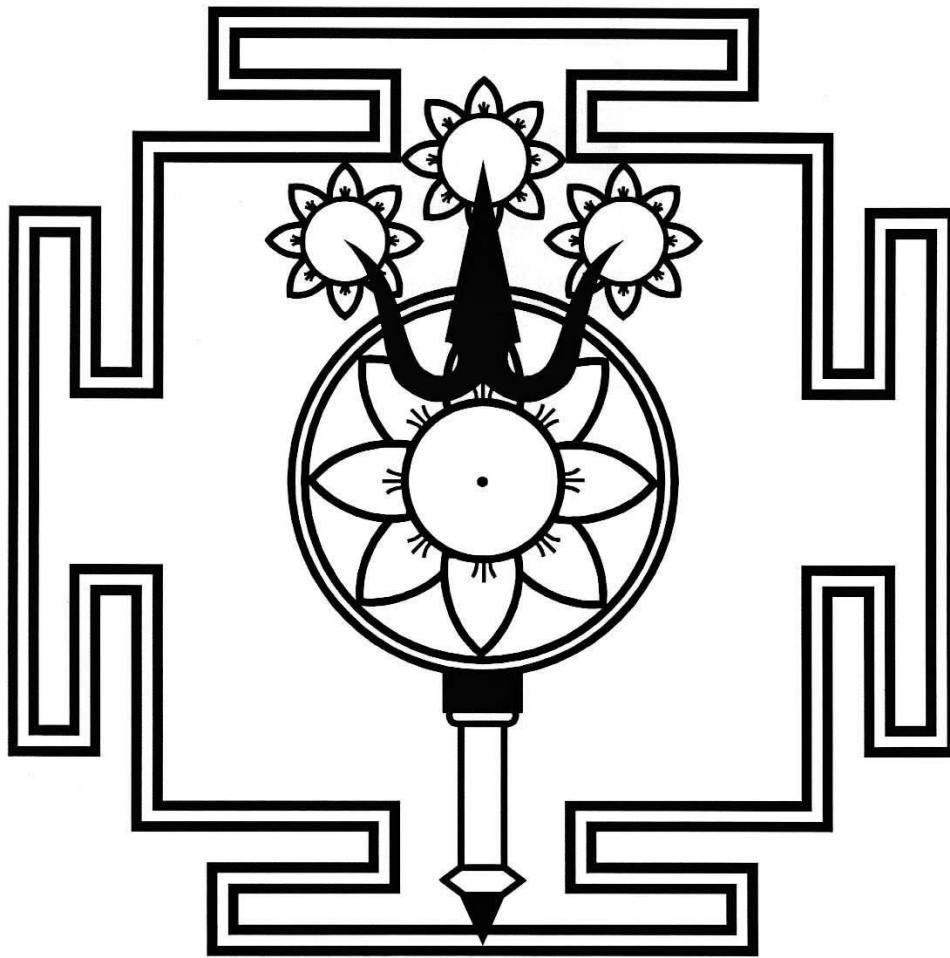


Paying homage to Lady Yeshe Tsogyal at her cave in Taktsang



Silent Gartitude

(Geetika)



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